Hinduism and Hindu Philosophy

There is a serious confusion in the minds of outsiders and some uninformed Indians, too, that Hinduism and Hindu philosophy are one and the same thing or that the latter is drawn from the former. Nothing can be more erroneous. The two are as poles apart as Christianity is from Western philosophy. The reflections of Plato and Aristotle, Locke, Descartes, Berkeley, logical positivism, the philosophy of analysis and phenomenology, and scientism have not concerned themselves at all with themes of Christianity. What is, one wonders, common between the Christianity of churches and the entire range of philosophical literature in the West. This parallels the case of Hinduism and Hindu philosophy. Hindu philosophy has taken an absolutely independent course from the earliest times of Sankhya and Yoga, Buddhism and Jainism to the Nyaya, Vedanta and Vaisesika, and has dealt with the problems of mind of all kinds, from absolute monism to pluralism, materialism to absolute idealism, from the distinctions between the universal and the particular, and finally the problems of relation itself. Hinduism has nothing at all to do with these hairsplitting problems of philosophy as Christianity has nothing to do with the problems with which Bradley and Bosanquit occupied their lives. Hinduism is a code of conduct based upon the concept of Hindu Dharma. With that go certain social institutions like Varna and Asrama Dharma sects for the attainment of *Moksa* (liberation) by *Bhakti* (devotion), or the worship of Siva and Visnu, or by *Jnana* (knowledge), or *Karma Margas* (action paths). Hinduism believes in immortality, transmigration of soul from body to body for innumerable years. Belief in God is universally held. All these matters are hardly dealt with either intensely or exclusively in any one of the major Indian philosophical schools or in the standard philosophical texts. Like Christianity, Hinduism is a set of beliefs, all unproven assumptions